



Product FAQ

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This FAQ document provides answers to common questions about Slack, the collaboration hub that brings teams together. Whether you're new to Slack or looking to optimize your team's usage, you'll find helpful information organized by category below.

Getting Started

Q: What is Slack?

Slack is a cloud-based collaboration platform that brings team communication and work into one place. It combines messaging, file sharing, voice and video calls, and integrations with other tools to help teams work more efficiently together. Slack organizes conversations into channels based on projects, topics, or teams, making it easy to stay organized and find information when you need it.

Q: How do I create a Slack workspace?

To create a Slack workspace, visit slack.com and click 'Get Started.' Enter your email address, and Slack will send you a confirmation code. Once verified, you'll be prompted to create your workspace by choosing a workspace name and URL. After setup, you can invite team members via email. The process takes just a few minutes, and you can start with a free plan to test it out.

Q: What's the difference between channels and direct messages?

Channels are shared spaces for team conversations organized by topic, project, or team. They can be public (visible to everyone in the workspace) or private (invite-only). Direct messages (DMs) are private conversations between specific individuals or small groups. Use channels for team discussions and project work, and DMs for quick private conversations or sensitive topics.

Q: How do I join or create a channel?

To join a public channel, click the '+' icon next to 'Channels' in your sidebar and browse available channels. Click any channel to preview it, then click 'Join Channel.' To create a new channel, click the same '+' icon and select 'Create a channel.' Choose a descriptive name, decide if it should be public or private, add a description, and invite relevant team members.

Features & Functionality

Q: Can I make voice and video calls in Slack?

Yes, Slack includes built-in voice and video calling features. You can start a call from any channel or direct message by clicking the phone or video camera icon. Slack supports one-on-one calls on all plans, while group calls and screen sharing are available on paid plans. Calls support up to 50 participants on Business+ and Enterprise Grid plans.

Q: How do Slack integrations work?

Slack integrations connect Slack with other tools your team uses, such as Google Drive, Zoom, Salesforce, or GitHub. You can install apps from the Slack App Directory by clicking your workspace name and selecting 'Apps.' Once installed, these apps can send notifications to channels, allow you to perform actions without leaving Slack, and streamline workflows by keeping all your tools connected in one place.

Q: What are Slack workflows and how do I use them?

Workflows are automated sequences of steps that help your team complete routine tasks in Slack. They can be triggered manually or automatically, and don't require coding knowledge. Use Workflow Builder (accessible from the Tools menu) to create custom workflows for common processes like onboarding new team members, submitting requests, or collecting feedback. You can also install pre-built workflows from the App Directory.

Q: How does search work in Slack?

Slack's search function lets you find messages, files, and conversations quickly. Click the search bar at the top of Slack or press Ctrl+K (Cmd+K on Mac) to search. You can use search modifiers like 'from:@username,' 'in:#channel,' or 'has:link' to narrow results. Slack also supports date filters and file type searches. All messages and files are searchable, making it easy to find important information from weeks or months ago.

Q: Can I schedule messages to send later?

Yes, you can schedule messages to be sent at a specific time. After typing your message, click the dropdown arrow next to the send button and select 'Schedule for later.' Choose a preset time or set a custom date and time. This is useful for composing messages outside work hours that will be delivered during business hours, or for coordinating announcements across time zones.

Pricing & Plans

Q: What's included in the Free plan?

The Free plan includes unlimited users, access to 10,000 most recent messages, 10 integrations, one-on-one voice and video calls, and 5 GB of file storage per workspace. It's great for small teams or those trying out Slack. However, you won't have access to message history beyond the most recent 10,000 messages, and some advanced features like group calls and unlimited integrations require a paid plan.

Q: What are the paid plan options?

Slack offers three paid plans: Pro (\$7.25/user/month billed annually), Business+ (\$12.50/user/month billed annually), and Enterprise Grid (custom pricing). Pro includes unlimited message history, unlimited integrations, and group calls. Business+ adds SAML-based single sign-on, compliance exports, and 99.99% uptime SLA. Enterprise Grid is designed for large organizations with unlimited workspaces, enterprise-grade security, and dedicated support.

Q: Can I try paid features before committing?

Yes, Slack offers free trials of paid plans. You can start a free trial of Pro or Business+ without entering credit card information. The trial typically lasts 30 days and gives you full access to all features included in that plan. After the trial ends, you'll be prompted to add payment information if you want to continue with the paid plan, or you can revert to the Free plan.

Q: Do I pay for guest users?

No, guest users don't count toward your billing. Guests are people outside your organization who you invite to specific channels. They have limited access compared to full members and can only see the channels they're invited to. This makes it cost-effective to collaborate with clients, contractors, or partners without paying for full Slack memberships.

Security & Privacy

Q: How secure is Slack?

Slack employs enterprise-grade security measures including data encryption in transit (TLS) and at rest (AES-256), regular security audits, and compliance with standards like SOC 2, SOC 3, and ISO 27001. Business+ and Enterprise Grid plans include additional security features like SAML-based SSO, data loss prevention, and enterprise key management. Slack also maintains a bug bounty program and publishes regular security updates.

Q: Can my employer see my direct messages?

Workspace owners and admins can request to export data from Slack, including direct messages, if they have a paid plan with data export features. However, this typically requires a legitimate business reason and users are usually notified. On the Free plan, workspace owners cannot export DMs. It's important to follow your organization's communication policies and treat Slack as a professional work tool. Check your workspace's data retention and export policies for specific details.

Q: How long does Slack retain my data?

Data retention depends on your plan and workspace settings. On the Free plan, Slack retains the 10,000 most recent messages. Paid plans retain all messages indefinitely by default, but workspace owners can configure custom retention policies to automatically delete messages after a specified period (ranging from 1 day to forever). This helps organizations comply with data retention regulations and manage storage costs.

Q: Is Slack GDPR compliant?

Yes, Slack is fully GDPR compliant. Slack provides tools for workspace owners to manage user data, including the ability to export or delete personal data upon request. Slack has appointed a Data Protection Officer, maintains detailed privacy documentation, and offers Data Processing Addendums for customers. Users in the EU benefit from the same security and privacy protections as all Slack users worldwide.

Troubleshooting & Support

Q: Slack notifications aren't working. How do I fix this?

First, check your notification settings by clicking your profile picture and selecting 'Preferences' > 'Notifications.' Ensure notifications are enabled for the channels and activities you care about. On desktop, check your computer's system notification settings to confirm Slack is allowed to send notifications. On mobile, verify that notifications are enabled in your device settings for the Slack app. If

issues persist, try logging out and back in, or reinstalling the app.

Q: Why can't I find a message I'm looking for?

If you can't find a message, it might be beyond the 10,000 message limit on the Free plan, or it might have been deleted by the user or by a retention policy. Try narrowing your search using filters like specific channels, dates, or users. If you're on a paid plan and still can't find it, the message may have been deleted. Contact your workspace admin if you believe a message should be accessible but isn't appearing in search.

Q: The Slack app keeps disconnecting. What should I do?

Frequent disconnections are often caused by network issues or firewall restrictions. Check your internet connection and ensure Slack's required ports and domains aren't blocked by your firewall or VPN. Try switching between WiFi and mobile data to isolate the issue. Clear the app cache, update to the latest version of Slack, or try the web version to see if the problem persists. If using a corporate network, contact your IT department to ensure Slack's connectivity requirements are met.

Q: How do I contact Slack support?

Slack offers several support options depending on your plan. All users can access the Help Center at slack.com/help for articles and guides. Paid plan users can submit support tickets directly from within Slack by clicking Help and selecting 'Contact us.' Business+ and Enterprise Grid customers have access to faster response times and can request priority support. You can also reach Slack on Twitter @SlackHQ for general inquiries.

Tips & Best Practices

Q: How can I organize channels effectively?

Use clear, descriptive naming conventions for channels, such as prefixes like '#proj-' for projects, '#team-' for teams, or '#help-' for support channels. Star your most important channels to keep them at the top of your sidebar. Create channel descriptions that explain the channel's purpose. Archive channels that are no longer active to reduce clutter. Consider creating private channels for sensitive discussions and public channels for transparency and discoverability.

Q: What are some keyboard shortcuts I should know?

Essential Slack keyboard shortcuts include: Ctrl+K (Cmd+K) to quickly jump to any channel or DM, Ctrl+/ (Cmd+/) to view all shortcuts, Up arrow to edit your last message, Ctrl+Shift+\ (Cmd+Shift+\) to toggle the sidebar, and Ctrl+Shift+K (Cmd+Shift+K) to browse all DMs. Learning these shortcuts can significantly speed up your Slack navigation and productivity.

Q: How can I reduce notification overload?

Customize your notifications by muting channels that aren't immediately relevant (right-click the channel and select 'Mute'). Set up notification schedules to pause notifications outside work hours. Use the 'Do Not Disturb' mode when you need focused time. Adjust keyword notifications to only alert you when specific words or phrases are mentioned. Encourage your team to use @mentions sparingly and only when someone's immediate attention is needed.

Additional Resources

Resource	Description
Slack Help Center	Comprehensive guides and documentation at slack.com/help
Slack Community	Connect with other users and get answers at slackcommunity.com
Slack App Directory	Browse and install integrations at slack.com/apps
Slack Training	Free courses and certifications at slack.com/resources
API Documentation	For developers building on Slack at api.slack.com

For questions not covered in this FAQ, please visit slack.com/help or contact your workspace administrator. Slack is continually adding new features and improvements, so check back regularly for updates to this document.